

Prayers of Care

Mission, Vision and Values

CARF Community Integration (BH) Binder — document MVV-01

DRAFT — no approval date, no effective date. Do not date until signed.

Owner: Tom Garner, Owner / Executive Director
Sole owner · 4–10 staff · already serving people
Status: DRAFT — not yet adopted, not yet effective
Prepared with Successful Solutions

Document ID	MVV-01
Version	Draft 1
Status	Draft → Approved → Trained → In use → Tested → Monitoring *(circle the current state)*
Owner	Tom Garner, Owner / Executive Director
Approver	Tom Garner, Owner / Executive Director
Approval date	_____
Effective date	_____
Review interval	Annually
Next review due	_____
Published at	_____
CARF areas served	1.A Leadership (p.31); referenced by 2.A Program/Service Structure (p.116) and 1.J Rights of Persons Served (p.89)

- > **Do not date this document until it is signed.** A policy that carries an effective date
- > earlier than its adoption is backdated, and one backdated date makes a surveyor doubt every
- > other date in the binder.

About this agency — confirmed by the Owner

Governance	Sole owner. No board of directors. The Owner performs the governance functions personally and records them. CARF 1.B Governance is titled "(Optional)" in the 2026 manual — confirm with your CARF resource specialist whether you are electing it.
Workforce	Owner plus 4–10 people
Operating status	Already serving people. The agency has service history to draw on.
Faith-based activity	None. See the Statement on Faith.

Purpose

State who we are and how we treat people. Guide hiring, peer practice, and Community Integration services. Give staff, persons served, referral sources and surveyors one consistent answer to "what is this agency for?"

Mission

Prayers of Care walks with people in recovery as they build meaningful lives in the community. We use peer support to help people choose their own goals, grow natural supports, and take part in everyday community life with dignity and hope.

Vision

Every person we serve has a valued role in their community — connected, supported, and free to define their own recovery.

Values, and what each one looks like in practice

A value a surveyor cannot observe is a slogan. Each value below carries the behaviour that evidences it, and where that evidence lives.

#	Value	What it means	What it looks like in practice	Where the evidence is
1	Person-centered choice	The person leads their plan.	Goals are recorded in the person's own words, in quotation marks. A person may decline any service without losing others.	Person-centered plans; declines documented without pejorative language
2	Hope and recovery	Recovery is possible and looks different for each person.	Staff speak about futures, not deficits. No pathway is promoted as superior.	Progress notes; supervision notes
3	Peer partnership	Lived experience is a strength we honour and use ethically.	Self-disclosure is purposeful, planned in writing, and reviewed at every supervision.	Personal disclosure plans; supervision notes

#	Value	What it means	What it looks like in practice	Where the evidence is
4	Belonging	Community integration means real participation, not isolation.	Service happens in real community settings. Unpaid supports are counted and grown.	Progress notes showing location; Natural Supports Map
5	Respect and inclusion	We welcome people of all backgrounds, beliefs and identities.	See the Statement on Faith below.	Rights acknowledgments; grievance log
6	Safety and integrity	We protect rights, privacy and honest practice.	We document what happened, never what should have happened.	Record reviews; incident log
7	Accountability	We measure what matters and improve when we fall short.	Results are published to staff and to the people we serve, including the bad ones.	Annual performance analysis; distribution log

Statement on Faith

****Read this section carefully. Because of our name, a surveyor will ask about it, and so will payers and referral sources.****

Prayers of Care is named for the care we give, not for a belief anyone is required to hold.

****Prayers of Care does not offer, provide, lead or host prayer, worship, devotional or religious activity as any part of its services.**** The name reflects the Owner's own values about how people should be cared for. It does not describe a service the agency delivers. That is the clearest and most defensible answer, and it is the true one.

The rest of this statement holds regardless:

1. ****No person is ever required to pray, hold any belief, attend any religious activity, or participate in any spiritual practice**** to receive services from Prayers of Care, to continue receiving them, or to receive any particular level of service.
2. **No service, referral, support or benefit is conditioned on a person's faith**, on their lack of faith, or on any change in either.
3. Spirituality is one of the life domains a person may choose to work on, because it matters to some people in recovery. **Staff follow the person's lead.** Staff do not introduce religious content, offer prayer, or share their own beliefs unless the person has asked.
4. **A person may ask for faith-based support and may decline it at any time**, and may change their mind, without any effect on their services and without having to give a reason.
5. **A person's religious belief or non-belief is not recorded** in their record unless the person has chosen it as part of their own goals and has said it may be written down.
6. **No staff member is required to hold or express any belief** as a condition of employment, and none may be pressured to participate in religious activity at work.
7. Any concern that this statement has not been honoured is a rights matter and is handled through the grievance process, which anyone may use without retaliation.

Cross-reference: this statement must also appear in the Rights of Persons Served material (CARF 1.J) and in the Program Description (CARF 2.A), and be covered at the orientation of every person served. It is not enough for it to live only here.

Because Prayers of Care is already serving people: everyone currently receiving services should be given this statement at their next contact, and the orientation record updated to show it. People already enrolled were oriented before this existed — catching them up is a short, honest task now, and an awkward gap at survey if it is left.

Policy

1. Leadership adopts the Mission, Vision and Values in writing, dated and signed.
2. Every employee, contractor, student, intern and volunteer receives them at hire and at

least annually thereafter, and the receipt is recorded.

3. Every person served is given them at orientation, in plain language.
4. All public material — website, brochures, signage, social media, grant applications and referral packets — matches the adopted wording. Nobody publishes a different version.
5. They are reviewed at least annually, and sooner if the services, the population served or the operating model changes materially.

Procedure

1. Leadership reviews this draft and edits the customise notes below.
2. Approver signs the adoption table. ****The approval date and the effective date are written on the day they actually happen**** — never in advance, never in arrears.
3. The document is published where staff and persons served can find it, and any earlier version is removed from circulation the same day.
4. Staff are given the adopted version and each signs the acknowledgment. New staff receive it during orientation, before independent contact with anyone served.
5. Persons served receive it at orientation; the orientation checklist records that.
6. The owner checks the website and printed material against the adopted wording, and records the check.
7. The review is completed by the next review date and recorded in the review table below, whether or not anything changed. *****"Reviewed, no change" is a complete review — an empty review row is not.****

Customise notes: `[FILL IN any wording changes before adoption — or write "none"]`

Adoption

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Owner / Executive Director	Tom Garner	_____	_____
Program Supervisor	`[FILL IN — name]`	_____	_____

Governing body: Prayers of Care has **no board of directors**. The Owner performs the governance functions personally — approving the mission, the strategic plan and the budget, reviewing organisational performance and risk, and ensuring legal and ethical operation — and records each one. There is no third signature line here because there is no third person, and an empty line for a body that does not exist is worse than no line at all.

Publication check

Where it must appear	Posted / updated?	Checked by	Date
Staff handbook			
Handbook or packet given to persons served			
Office wall / lobby			
Website			
Brochures and referral packets			
Social media profiles			

Staff acknowledgment

One row per person, at hire and annually. This is the evidence that item 2 of the Policy actually happened.

For staff already employed on the day this is adopted: they sign on the day they actually receive the adopted version. **Do not backdate the acknowledgment to their hire date.** The agency was already operating before this document existed, and a signature dated before the document was approved is the single easiest inconsistency for a surveyor to spot. A row that reads "received 2026-09-XX" for someone hired last year is honest and completely fine.

Name	Role	Received at hire (date)	Annual re-issue (date)	Signature
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Annual review record

Review due	Review completed (date)	Reviewed by	Changes made, or "reviewed, no change"	New version number
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What a surveyor will ask about this document

They ask	They are testing	What has to be true
"What is your mission?" — asked of a peer specialist , not of you	Whether the mission is lived or laminated	Staff can say it in their own words. Word-perfect recitation is not required and looks rehearsed.
"Does anyone have to pray to get services here?"	Rights, and your name	An immediate, confident "no" from any staff member and any person served
"How do staff know these values?"	1.A and 1.I	Signed acknowledgments, and the values covered at orientation
"Show me where this is posted."	Whether policy meets practice	It is actually on the wall and in the handbook
"Does your website say the same thing?"	Consistency	It does — and someone checked, and recorded the check
"When was this last reviewed?"	1.A	A completed row in the review table, dated within twelve months

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